



leadership of the Prime Minister. We understand our responsibility and the role we have to play and we will take those efforts forward.

Q: India has faced criticism over its 2070 Net Zero target despite its low emission share. What's your view?

A: Yes, we are the fourth-largest polluter in the world. Let us assume our share in carbon emissions is 4.5%. But we constitute 17% of the world's population. I will not name all the developed countries, but countries in Europe also account for 17% of the global population. If we add their cumulative carbon emissions it comes up to 60% of the world's total. How then are we among the biggest?

My point is that despite being the fourth-largest polluter in the world, we are even below Ethiopia in terms of per capita emissions because that is our lifestyle. Our per capita plastic consumption is 35 kg and Europe's is 100 kg. We are effecting changes in the consumption pattern of our people even with such a large population. We have to fulfil our responsibilities. And we have also said on the fight against fossil fuel, that the principle of common and differentiated responsibility is subject to poverty alleviation. If any country has to progress today, access to energy will have to be provided to all its people. There should be a right to energy. An electric bulb will have to be lit

in the house of every person in every village, hut, or tribal settlement if you want to give people a dignified life. How can we stop doing that?

Q: What role can the corporate sector play in achieving environment targets?

A: We should not just assign compliance responsibilities. The Prime Minister's vision is that we should also change our rules to improve the ease of doing business. When the BJP government took office, it used to take 600 days for environment clearance in this country. Today, that has come down to 75 days. We have also launched the Parivesh portal to provide all clearances through a single-window system.

Our large companies should definitely increase their social responsibilities. But more research should be done on technology and innovation. They should collaborate with universities, like the Indian Institutes of Technology, and promote start-ups. The government is also trying to strengthen the capacity of the private sector. If that strengthens, then one day India can become the world's largest economy and offer a good lifestyle to its people.

Q: Is there a need for government support for industrial decarbonisation?

| 35

A: The government will support all industries. The country grows when industry grows. I am very clear about this. There are two ways to grow. First is the ease of doing business. The government is fully committed to it. Second is capacity building. We have an international collaboration with Sweden to bring in new technology in 'hard to abate' industries, build capacity, innovate and conduct research. In this, we should work together with the rest of the world and the government is fully prepared to take this forward. **The government's policies and the vision of the Prime Minister of a developed India aim to strengthen the private sector so that we can generate employment and make India the largest economy.**

Q: Is greenwashing a concern?

A: I would like to say this to the private sector: don't just be transparent, be honest. The government wants to improve the ease of doing business. Build trust, since trust is the only thing that can take everyone forward. Everyone should trust each other and their accounts too [smiles]. Where there is trust there is truth. If we follow both, then the country will definitely progress. **BT**

@sazarabi